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Register a U.S. Company from Papua New Guinea

Form a Wyoming LLC yourself — online, with your Visa card. No SSN. No expensive middleman.

What this guide does

A U.S. LLC (Limited Liability Company) lets you run a business under a U.S. entity — useful for opening U.S. bank accounts, accepting payments like Stripe or PayPal, and working with U.S. clients. This guide walks you through forming one in **Wyoming**, the cheapest and most non-resident-friendly state, entirely from Papua New Guinea.

One honest note about “fully online.” Forming the company and paying the fee is 100% online with your Visa card. The single exception is the tax ID (EIN): because you have no U.S. Social Security Number, the IRS online tool is blocked for you. You send one form by phone or fax instead — free, and explained in Step 5. Everything else is click-and-done.

What it costs (at a glance)

Item	Cost	How often
Wyoming Articles of Organization (state filing fee)	US\$100	Once
Online payment convenience fee	~US\$3.75	Once
Registered agent (required for non-residents)	US\$25–US\$150	Every year
EIN (tax ID) from the IRS	FREE	Once
Operating Agreement (you write it)	FREE	Once
Annual Report / license tax	US\$60	Every year
Typical first-year total (doing it yourself)	~US\$130–US\$260	Year 1

The EIN is **always free** from the IRS — anyone charging you for it is charging for their time, not the number.

The steps, one by one

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Get ready (about 5 minutes)

Have these ready before you start:

- A Visa or Mastercard **debit card** that allows international / online payments.
- An email address you check often.
- Your passport (you will need it later, for the bank).
- Two or three possible company names.

This guide uses **Wyoming** because it is cheap, private, has no state income tax, and welcomes owners who live outside the U.S.

1

Pick your company name and check it is free

Your name must be unique and must end with “LLC” or “Limited Liability Company.” Search it first — if it is taken, your filing will be rejected.

Search here: [wyobiz.wyo.gov — Business Name Search](https://wyobiz.wyo.gov/BusinessNameSearch)

2

Get a Registered Agent (the one thing you cannot skip)

Wyoming law requires a **registered agent** with a real street address inside Wyoming (no P.O. box). Because you live in PNG, you cannot be your own agent — you must hire one.

- Sign up on the agent’s website and pay with your Visa card (about US\$25–US\$150 per year).
- They give you a Wyoming address and permission to be listed — you need this in Step 3.

Example provider (not an endorsement): [Northwest Registered Agent](#). Many agents will also file your Articles for you at no service charge — you still pay the US\$100 state fee.

3

File your Articles of Organization online — US\$100

This is the step that actually creates your LLC. Go to the Wyoming portal and choose “File Articles of Organization” for an LLC.

File here: wyobiz.wyo.gov

You do NOT upload any documents here — it is a simple web form. You type in:

- Your LLC name (exactly as you searched it).
- Your registered agent’s name and Wyoming address (from Step 2).
- Your mailing and principal office address — **your PNG home address is fine.**
- Your name as the organizer, your email, and an electronic signature.

Pay US\$100 + about US\$3.75 with your Visa card. Approval is usually immediate to a few days.

Download and save your approved Articles of Organization PDF — it is your first official document.

4

Write your Operating Agreement (free)

This is an **internal** document — you do not send it to anyone. Download a free single-member LLC operating agreement template, fill in your name and 100% ownership, sign it, and save it. Your bank will ask to see it later.

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Get your EIN (tax ID) from the IRS — free

An EIN is your company's tax ID. You need it to open a bank account. As a PNG resident with no U.S. Social Security Number you cannot use the IRS online tool — but the EIN is still **free**.

1. Download Form SS-4: [irs.gov — Form SS-4 \(PDF\)](https://www.irs.gov/efile/efile-ss-4) (help: [SS-4 instructions](#)).
2. Fill it in. On **line 7b** write **"Foreign"**. List yourself as the responsible party, title "Member." Use your registered agent's U.S. address as the business address.
3. Send it to the IRS — choose one:
 - **Phone (fastest):** call **+1 267-941-1099** (Mon–Fri, 6am–11pm U.S. Eastern). They can read you the EIN on the call.
 - **Fax from outside the U.S.: 304-707-9471.** Use a free online fax service — no machine needed. You get the EIN back in about 4 business days.
4. Save the **CP 575** letter the IRS sends back — it proves your EIN, and a replacement takes weeks. Not sure which fax to use? Check [the IRS "Where to File" page](#).

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Set up money: banking & payments (uploads happen here)

Now apply for a U.S. business account or payment platform — for example Mercury, Payoneer, Wise, or a Stripe / PayPal business account. **This is the stage where you finally upload documents:**

- Your Articles of Organization (from Step 3).
- Your EIN / CP 575 letter (from Step 5).
- Your Operating Agreement (from Step 4).
- Your passport, for identity.

Moving money between PNG and the U.S. is the trickiest part — plan for currency conversion and your PNG bank's requirements.

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Stay compliant every year (do not skip this)

Three things to repeat every year to keep your company alive and legal:

- **Annual Report — US\$60**, filed at [wyobiz.wyo.gov](https://www.wyobiz.wyo.gov), due on the 1st day of your formation month.
 - **Renew your registered agent** (their yearly fee).
 - **File Form 5472 + a "pro forma" Form 1120** with the IRS. Required for foreign-owned single-member LLCs, and the penalty for missing it is **US\$25,000**. Due around April 15.
- Form 5472 details: [irs.gov — About Form 5472](https://www.irs.gov/efile/efile-5472)

Your documents — a quick map

Stage	Document
Prepare before you start	Passport · Visa card · chosen company name
You receive & keep	Approved Articles of Organization · EIN letter (CP 575)
You create & keep	Operating Agreement
You upload (banking stage only)	All of the above + your passport

DO IT WITH A GUIDE BESIDE YOU

Use Claude AI as your assistant

The small details are what trip people up — a name already taken, the wrong box on Form SS-4, a deadline that slips by. **Claude AI** is the ideal assistant to walk you through every step of this guide in plain, patient language. Free to start, available any time of day.

Ask Claude to:

- brainstorm company names and tell you what to check;
- fill in Form SS-4 line by line for your exact situation;
- draft your Operating Agreement from your details;
- explain any rejection message and how to fix it;
- track your yearly deadlines (Annual Report, Form 5472);
- write a “reasonable cause” letter if you ever file something late.

Think of Claude as a knowledgeable friend who has done this before — patient with beginners, and able to explain each U.S. form in words that make sense.

Start here: claude.ai

Important. This guide is general information, not legal or tax advice. State fees and IRS procedures can change — always confirm the current details on the official **.gov** websites linked above (sos.wyo.gov, wyobiz.wyo.gov, irs.gov). Foreign-owned LLCs have a yearly Form 5472 duty with heavy penalties for missing it; for your specific situation, consider a licensed U.S. tax professional.